EL NIÑO ACTION BRIEFING · 8 OCTOBER 2026

Bela Vista, São Paulo

In Bela Vista, El Niño's danger is heat that kills indoors and goes uncounted: an older person alone in an upper-floor flat or a windowless cortiço room, often after a windstorm has cut the power, recorded weeks later as a heart attack or stroke. The most important step is a named roster of those people, built now, and someone who knocks on every 32°C day.

IMPACT REGION	EXCESS HEAT DEATHS	WINDOW	DOMINANT HAZARD
São Paulo municipality (inferred; ~11.4M people, far above the ~300k norm)	Brazil 13,300; no São Paulo figure published	Sep 2026 – Feb 2027 (Brazil Dec–Feb: 8,000)	Heat, with windstorm blackouts (Sep–Dec); flash floods on the buried Saracura (Jan–Mar)

13/13 recommendations checked. 0 confirmed outright, 8 corrected, 2 unverified, 3 contraindicated: handing out fans to older people, a parametric heat-income policy for delivery riders, and using the Enel concession-cancellation process as a lever before December. The funding placements were checked separately. Fans and the Missão Paz cash transfers were cut. **The funding target fell 41%**, from US$107k to US$63k, which is more than the one-third tolerance. Exposure: Climate Impact Lab, 451,000 at Risk, September 2026, pre-peer-review. It projects 13,300 excess heat deaths for Brazil in Sep 2026 – Feb 2027 and publishes no sub-national figure. São Paulo municipality holds about 5.6% of Brazil's population (11.45M of 203.1M, 2022 census), so **a population-scaled figure would be ~750, which is our arithmetic and not an Impact**

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY — AT A GLANCE



23.56°S 46.65°W, Brazil · Natural Earth

- **The risk.** Indoor heat kills isolated older people, often after windstorm blackouts: in 2023 a 3 November windstorm killed 7 and cut power to over 2 million, then 37.7°C arrived, and no heat toll was published.
- **First action.** UBS Humaitá teams, Achiropita, SASF, and building staff build a roster of isolated, bedbound, and cortiço residents in October, then phone or knock on every 32°C day to March.
- **The money.** US$59k (R$320k) floor, US$63k (R$340k) target, US$113k (R$610k) ceiling; the top-ranked placement is Achiropita's paid visitors and cooled hall, R$140k (US$26k).
- **Do not.** Do not hand out fans to older people: São Paulo's heat passes 35°C, above which fans are advised against for over-65s, dry heat can add strain, and blackouts stop them.*

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* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Lab finding; the model treats age, income, and adaptive capacity explicitly, and a flat scaling does not.

Read this first: the window is now, and the deaths are not being counted. São Paulo's clearest El Niño case, 2023, brought the 3 November windstorm (7 dead, more than 2 million without power for about four days) and, ten days later, 37.7°C at Mirante de Santana, the second-highest reading since 1943. No official São Paulo heat death toll was ever published for it. In Rio the same month, 1,392 excess deaths were counted, many of them at home. The CPC declared El Niño on 10 September 2026 with a very strong event likely by October–December, so heat and wind risk is highest between now and December. Floods are different: they still cluster in January–March. One caveat on timing: two other spring extremes often cited (37.8°C on 17 October 2014, and the 11 October 2024 windstorm) were not El Niño events, so "spring" is a strong hypothesis from one clear year, not an established rule.

WHAT THIS PLACE SHOULD DO — RANKED

Actions are ranked by expected lives saved per unit of effort before the peak. The backing lenses are shown on each action, and the RACI chart below assigns each one. One rule underlies every action: trigger on the city's own 32°C threshold (air temperature or heat index, per the CGE), which is already law under Portaria 362/2025, rather than on a season.

1. Build a roster of older people living alone, bedbound residents, and cortiço households, and phone or knock on every 32°C day

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | PUBLIC HEALTH · EMERGENCY MGR · FRONTLINE · SKEPTIC · HISTORIAN · PHILANTHROPIST | INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
UBS Humaitá family-health teams and community health agents; Obras Sociais Nossa Senhora Achiropita (elder centre); SASF; building porteiros and síndicos	Roster now, in October; checks on every Level 1 day to March	Staff time at the UBS; R$140k (US$26k) for paid visitors and a cooled hall (see funding)	Deaths at home of isolated, bedbound, and upper-floor older people

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Bela Vista had 60,024 residents in 2022 at 221 people per hectare, about 1.97 per occupied home. SEHAB counts about 1,080 cortiços in the centre; a USP estimate puts about 18,000 people in them, and Bela Vista is one of the named clusters. The city's 5-level heat protocol (Portaria 362/2025) has no welfare-check step: Level 1 is SMS alerts and the street tents, and older people get priority at health units only at Level 4 (40–42°C). Achiropita's elder centre serves 130 people aged 60 and over, 40 of them through home visits, so the visiting model already exists. Each visit should prescribe skin wetting and a move to a cool room, not a fan (see contraindicated).

Corrections: there is no “UBS Bela Vista”; the district's unit is UBS Humaitá (Rua Humaitá 520), whose family-health teams had only about 3,600 registered families in 2020 against roughly 30,400 occupied homes, so most of the roster has to come from Achiropita, SASF, and building staff. The “1.46 per household” figure divided by all dwellings, including the 24% that are empty. No count of over-60s living alone exists for the district. Evidence: in Chicago in 1995, living alone (OR 2.3) and being bedbound (OR 8.2) were the strongest risk factors for heat death (Semenza et al., *NEJM* 1996, case-control, associations not causal effects). Montreal's whole heat plan averted about 1.9 deaths per hot day after adjusting for displacement (Benmarhnia et al., *EHP* 2016). Both come from North American cities, so they are extrapolated.

2. Put one of the city's heat tents inside Bela Vista and keep a rest-and-water point open into the evening

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | EMERGENCY MGR · ECONOMIST · PHILANTHROPIST · SKEPTIC · FRONTLINE | INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
SMADS (Operação Altas Temperaturas); Subprefeitura Sé; SEFRAS at Chá do Padre (evening point)	**Ask SMADS in October; tent sited by 1 Dec; evening point for the 12 peak weeks**	**Tent within the existing SMADS contract (no unit cost published); R$180k (US$33k) for 16h–22h (see funding)**	**Heat stress among unhoused people in the hours after the tents close**

Operação Altas Temperaturas switches on whenever the temperature or heat index reaches 32°C. It is not seasonal, and SMADS ran it in spring 2025. It runs 10 tents citywide from 10h to 16h. The only central ones are at Praça da República and Praça Marechal Deodoro, so none is in Bela Vista or Sé. On 11 February 2025 it served 37,714 people. The ask is a tent at Praça 14 Bis, lower Paulista, or Bixiga, and cover for the evening, when heat stress stays high and the tents have shut. SEFRAS already runs Chá do Padre (Rua Riachuelo 268) under SMADS partnership 111/SMADS/2025, so the evening hours are a top-up to an existing operator.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Corrections: the lenses' premise that the operation “waits for summer” was wrong; it is trigger-based. The “launched February 2024” date is unverified (first confirmed activation: 11 February 2025). The tents are shade and water, not air-conditioned, and a CDC review found no direct evidence that cooling centres reduce deaths, so treat this as harm reduction. Whether a new site can be added inside the contract before December is unverified. SEFRAS should budget only the added evening hours, not services SMADS already pays for.

3. Pause zeladoria removals on heat-alert days, and take water and shade to where people already sleep

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | SKEPTIC · FRONTLINE | INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Subprefeitura Sé (zeladoria); SMADS; Consultório na Rua teams at UBS Sé	**Administrative instruction by 1 Nov**	**~R$0; an instruction, not a new decree**	**Losing shade, water, and medicines on the hottest days; people pushed away from outreach**

Decree 57.069/2016, amended by Decree 57.581/2017, already bars confiscating survival items such as blankets, mattresses, and documents, and requires SMADS to be told before zeladoria operations. Nothing pauses removals during heat alerts, and the heat-operation notices do not mention zeladoria. A municipal subcommittee minute records blankets and backpacks still being taken. UBS Sé runs two Consultório na Rua teams; on alert days they can carry water and sunscreen to the sleeping spots on Nove de Julho and under the Minhocão.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Corrections: a court did order belongings returned on a Defensoria action, but its “2018” date is unverified. No heat-specific zeladoria case was found. Whether Consultório na Rua teams cover Bela Vista itself was not verified.

4. Count deaths daily during every heat alert, through the channel that worked in 2014

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | PUBLIC HEALTH · EMERGENCY MGR · HISTORIAN | INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
SMS CEInfo and PRO-AIM, with the Serviço Funerário	Set up in October; run on every Level 1 day	Staff time	Finding out weeks later that a heat wave killed hundreds, and having no way to judge whether actions 1–3 worked

Heat deaths here are certified as cardiovascular, stroke, and other causes, so they never appear as heat deaths. The city has done this before: during the February 2014 heat wave, CEInfo counted 743 excess deaths in 2–15 February (30% above expected) using Serviço Funerário and PRO-AIM data. Greater São Paulo had 14,850 heat-wave excess deaths over 2000–2018, the most of Brazil's 14 largest urban areas (Monteiro dos Santos et al., *PLOS ONE* 2024), with higher rates among Black and brown men over 65.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Corrections: the Registro Civil portal is not usable for this, because registrations can take up to 14 days to appear. PRO-AIM averaged about 3.5 days to process a declaration in 2020, so burial records give the earliest signal. The “394 deaths, 70% from the heat island” figure for 2014 is a model estimate (Moraes et al., *Urban Climate* 2024), not a count.

5. Prepare for a multi-day blackout: register power-dependent residents with Enel, and put backup power at the UBS and shelters

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | HISTORIAN · SKEPTIC · EMERGENCY MGR · ECONOMIST | INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
UBS Humaitá (identifies home-oxygen and device users); Enel SP (registration); SMADS (shelter generators); building síndicos	Registrations and building plans by 15 Nov, ahead of the spring storm season's tail	Registration free; generator rental not quantified (*unfunded*)	A windstorm outage turning the next heat day into deaths among people on home oxygen and upper-floor residents without water or lifts

Enel SP outages hit about 2.1 million addresses on 3 November 2023 and again on 11 October 2024 (214,000 still out after four days), and the 10 December 2025 cyclone cut more. In a high-rise, the water pumps and lifts stop with the power. Under ANEEL REN 1000/2021, a registered electricity-dependent customer gets 5 working days' notice of planned cuts and a written, proven-delivery notice before any cut for non-payment. Tell upper-floor older residents to keep water and to know where the nearest ground-floor cool room is.*

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Corrections: registration does not ban non-payment cuts and gives no regulatory right to priority restoration, so backup power is the real protection. “Water lost after 48 hours” is unverified; pumps stop at once and supply depends on the roof tank. The R$165.8M ANEEL fine for 2023 was upheld in April 2024 and is only reportedly suspended in court. The roughly 7 deaths per storm are storm deaths, not deaths shown to be caused by the outage.

6. Clear the Saracura and Anhangabaú drains, close the Nove de Julho tunnel and underpasses on CGE alerts, and sign cortiço residents up to SMS alerts

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | EMERGENCY MGR · HISTORIAN · SKEPTIC | INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Subprefeitura Sé; CGE; Defesa Civil; volunteers for the 40199 sign-up	Drains and closure plan by 30 Nov, before the January–March flood season	Routine maintenance budget	Drowning and car entrapment in the valleys over the buried Saracura

The Saracura runs under Av. Nove de Julho, which opened over it in the late 1930s. It overflowed on 25 January 2021 (19 flood points), and the Line 6 Saracura/14 Bis metro worksite flooded on 5 March 2024. The February 24-hour record at Mirante de Santana, 121.8 mm, fell on 2 February 1983 in a strong El Niño. Anyone can text their CEP to 40199 for Defesa Civil alerts. The message is shelter upward and do not drive.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Corrections: the “two cars swept away on Rua Paim” in 2024 comes only from the Mobiliza Saracura Vai-Vai movement and is unconfirmed. The “Saracura buried 1906” date was not found. The 2021 Anhangabaú drainage plan's infiltration plaza on Nove de Julho went to public consultation (SIURB/ATNP-002/2026) in April 2026 and will not be built this season.

7. Help cortiço households qualify for the free first 80 kWh a month: update CadÚnico and fix the account holder

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED · ECONOMIST · INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
CRAS Sé and SASF (CadÚnico); Centro Gaspar Garcia de Direitos Humanos (tenant support); Enel SP	Drives in October–November	Staff time; the discount is paid by the CDE sector levy	Families switching off what cooling they have because of the bill; low yield

Lei 15.235/2025 gives a 100% discount on the first 80 kWh a month to CadÚnico households earning up to half a minimum wage per person. Enrolment fell nationally from 17.18M to 16.59M units between April 2025 and April 2026. A shared meter does not block it: REN 1000 Art. 179 §3 multiplies the limits by the number of eligible families.

Corrections: enrolment alone fails in cortiços. REN 1.147/2025 requires the account holder to match the CadÚnico record, and tenants rarely hold the account; an irregular connection has to be regularised first. Ranked low because it protects bills more than lives.

8. Translate the heat and flood alerts into Haitian Creole, French, and Spanish, and carry them through trusted people

UNVERIFIED · FRONTLINE · PHILANTHROPIST · INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Missão Paz; Achiropita; Vai-Vai and Mobiliza Saracura networks	Cards printed by 1 Nov	R$20k (US$3.7k) (see funding)	Migrants in cortiços missing warnings issued only in Portuguese

Newer cortiço residents are Haitian and African (Câmara SP). Missão Paz in Glicério, next to Bela Vista, serves about 5,000–7,000 migrants a year from 118 countries. The frontline lens was blunt: nobody in a cortiço opens the door to a clipboard; they open it to someone from Vai-Vai or the Achiropita festa.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Not verified: the share of migrants in Bela Vista's cortiços, and whether Missão Paz has run alerts before. Bolivian presence in Bixiga specifically was not found.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

WHO DOES WHAT

RACI CHART

R = Responsible (does the work) · **A** = Accountable (one per action; signs off and answers for it) · **C** = Consulted (asked before) · **I** = Informed (told after). Built from the owners named in the verified actions. No one here has been contacted or has agreed to a role; every row is a proposal.

Action	UBS Humaitá (SMS)	Achiropita	SMADS	SEFRAS	Subprefeitura Sé	CGE / Defesa Civil	CEInfo / PRO-AIM	Consultório na Rua	Enel SP	CRAS / SASF	Missão Paz	Residents & volunteers
1. Roster of isolated, bedbound, and cortiço residents; checks on 32°C days	**A**	**R**	**C**			**I**				**R**		**R**
2. Heat tent in Bela Vista; evening point	**C**		**A**	**R**	**R**	**C**		**C**				
3. Pause zeladoria on alert days; water to sleeping spots	**C**		**C**		**A**			**R**				
4. Daily death count during alerts	**I**		**I**			**I**	**A/R**					
5. Blackout plan: Enel registration, backup power	**R**	**C**	**R**		**C**	**C**			**A**			**R**
6. Drains, tunnel closures, 40199 sign-up					**A**	**R**						**R**
7. Free 80 kWh: CadÚnico and account holder			**C**						**R**	**A**		**R**
8. Alerts in Haitian Creole, French, and Spanish		**R**				**C**					**A**	**R**

What the chart shows. **The city carries most of this, not the neighbourhood**: SMS, SMADS, and the Subprefeitura are accountable on six of eight rows (counting CRAS/SASF, which SMADS runs), so the first job for anyone in Bela Vista is to ask them. **The most important action rests on thin capacity**: UBS Humaitá's family-health teams reach roughly one home in eight, so Achiropita and building staff have to carry the roster. **Enel is accountable on action 5 only for registration**; the backup power that actually protects people has no payer.

WHERE MONEY DOES THE MOST

FUNDING

The Philanthropist lens, reconciled against the ranked actions and verified. Placements are ranked by marginal lives saved per dollar. The envelope is bounded by what this place can spend before the peak, not by what it needs. Amounts at R$5.40 per US$.

FLOOR

US$59k (R$320k)

TARGET

US$63k (R$340k)

CEILING

US$113k (R$610k)

LARGEST UNCERTAINTY

Whether Achiropita can spend R$140k by December; its only documented city grant is R$44,682

Floor: Achiropita R$140k (10 paid visitors × R$2,000/month × 4 months = R$80k, plus oral rehydration salts and water R$20k, plus running a cooled parish hall R$40k) + SEFRAS R$180k (R$15k/week × 12 weeks) = R$320k. **Target:** + Missão Paz alerts R$20k = R$340k. **Ceiling:** + R$270k contingency released on an INMET red heat alert = R$610k. The target fell 41% in verification, from US$107k: fans (R$60k) were cut as contraindicated and the Missão Paz cash transfers (R$180k) were dropped as unverified. All unit costs are lens estimates, not quotes.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

RECIPIENT	USE	AMOUNT	MECHANISM	BASIS	VERDICT
Obras Sociais Nossa Senhora Achiropita (Rua Treze de Maio 478)	Action 1: paid visitors and a cooled hall	R$140k (US$26k)	Direct grant	Runs an elder centre for 130 people with 40 home visits; the R$44,682 is a one-off equipment grant, not a contract, so R$140k is ~3× its only documented grant	PARTIALLY CONFIRMED
SEFRAS (Chá do Padre, Rua Riachuelo 268)	Action 2: 16h–22h rest and water point	R$180k (US$33k)	Top-up to SMADS partnership 111/2025	Existing city partner; budget only the added evening hours	PARTIALLY CONFIRMED
Missão Paz (Glicério)	Action 8: multilingual alerts	R$20k (US$3.7k)	Direct grant	Serves 5,000–7,000 migrants a year; no alert track record found	UNVERIFIED
Missão Paz	Cash to 300 migrant cortiço households	$0 (was R$180k)	n/a	No cash programme on record; no causal evidence that cash reduces heat harm	DROPPED
Achiropita	300 fans	$0 (was R$60k)	n/a	São Paulo's heat waves pass the 35°C line above which fans are advised against for people over 65	CONTRAINDICATED
(no recipient named)	Contingency on an INMET red alert	R$270k (US$50k), ceiling only	Pledge, released on trigger	Who holds and spends it is unresolved	UNVERIFIED

The funder's one thing: the cheapest life saved in Bela Vista is not a grant. A citywide heat-warning system has cost about US$1,800 per life (Philadelphia, 117 lives for about US$210k over 1995–98, Ebi et al. 2004), far below any neighbourhood grant. Spend the first effort getting SMADS to site a tent in Bela Vista and CEInfo to run the daily death count, both free to a funder, then pay only for what the city will not do: knocking on the doors of people who live alone. Nothing here is pre-arranged. The Anticipation Hub lists no active anticipatory framework for Brazil, Brazil is in no sovereign risk pool, and the Brazilian Red Cross has never received an IFRC DREF for heat. It could request an imminent-crisis DREF (realistically CHF 50–250k) if a red alert is forecast, but that is a first, not a fallback.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

DO NOT DO THIS CONTRAINDICATED

Advice that circulates for this hazard and would cost lives or waste the window here.

Hand out fans to older people, or tell them to “stay home with a fan”*

CONTRAINDICATED

On 12–14 November 2023 São Paulo reached 37.1–37.7°C, with a low-humidity alert on the 12th. A 2024 *Lancet Planetary Health* review (Meade et al.) advises against fans above about 35°C for people aged 65 and over, and a 2016 *JAMA* trial (Gagnon et al.) found fans gave older adults no protection at 42°C. In dry heat a fan can add heat strain. It also fails in the blackouts that hit this city in 2023 and 2024.

Instead: skin wetting with water, a move to a cool ground-floor or shaded room, and the visit in action 1.

Buy parametric heat-income cover for app delivery riders, triggered at 35°C at Mirante de Santana

CONTRAINDICATED AS WRITTEN

The Economist proposed R$30–50 a trigger day, paid by the platforms and tied to council bill PL 161/2025. That bill covers only municipal civil servants and outsourced public-administration workers, not couriers, and its status is unknown. No Brazilian parametric heat-income product exists; the market is agricultural and corporate, R$21.6M insured in 2024. Mirante de Santana reaches 35°C on only a few days, not every year, and the peaks cluster in September–November. Nothing could be bound before the peak, and the expected payout would be tiny.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Instead: put this winter's money into actions 1 and 2, and press the platforms directly for paused deliveries and water points on Level 1 days.

Use the Enel SP concession-cancellation process to win heat-season obligations before December

CONTRAINDICATED AS A PRE-DECEMBER LEVER

ANEEL opened the caducidade procedure in April 2026. On 6 October the vote stood 2–0 for recommending Enel's exit when a director asked for more time, which pushes a decision to about early December, and the recommendation then goes to the Ministry of Mines and Energy. There is no public-comment window to use, nothing would land this season, and new obligations pass through into tariffs, so they are not free.

Instead: register power-dependent residents now and fund backup power (action 5). The longer-term route is the Enel SP Conselho de Consumidores or the Defensoria.

Also avoid (lens advice, consistent with verified evidence): pointing people to distant tents (none is in Bela Vista; action 2 fixes that). Calling for evacuation by car in a Saracura flash flood; shelter upward instead. Timing an awareness campaign for January, when 2023's heat and wind came in November. Messaging only about water, which ignores the pumps and lifts that stop in a blackout. And Vai-Vai's Carnaval rehearsals, which peak in January–February, could use hydration points and heat-stress spotters; this is frontline-lens advice and was not separately verified.

WHAT HAS HAPPENED HERE BEFORE — THE RECORD

YEAR	EVENT	TOLL	WHAT CHANGED AFTER
2 Feb 1983	121.8 mm in 24 h at Mirante de Santana, a strong El Niño	February 24-hour record	Valley-floor avenues over buried streams kept flooding
Feb 2014	Heat wave	743 excess deaths, 2–15 Feb (CEInfo)	The city showed it can count heat deaths; no standing heat plan followed

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

YEAR	EVENT	TOLL	WHAT CHANGED AFTER
2014–15	Water crisis; Cantareira falls to 8.2% and draws dead volume (16 May 2014)	No death toll	The state acted only below 10%
17 Oct 2014	37.8°C, the all-time record (borderline ENSO, not an El Niño event)	Not counted	None recorded
10 Feb 2020	114 mm in 24 h; Tietê and Pinheiros overflow	932 flood incidents attended; 7,600 calls	Piscinão programme; 6 delivered in 2021–25 against a target of 19
25 Jan 2021	Saracura overflows at Av. Nove de Julho	19 flood points	2021 Anhangabaú drainage plan; plaza still in consultation in 2026
3 Nov 2023	Windstorm; Enel blackout (strong El Niño)	7 dead; more than 2M without power for ~4 days	ANEEL fine of R$165.8M, upheld April 2024
13–14 Nov 2023	37.7°C, second-highest since 1943 (strong El Niño)	No São Paulo count; Rio had 1,392 excess deaths that month	5-level heat protocol, Portaria 362/2025 (February 2025)
5 Mar 2024	Storm floods the Line 6 Saracura/14 Bis worksite	Two cars on Rua Paim (claimed, unconfirmed)	None recorded
11 Oct 2024	107 km/h winds (ENSO-neutral)	~7 storm deaths; 2.1M without power, 214k after 4 days	ANEEL opens caducidade, April 2026
Dec 2025	Cyclone outage (10 Dec); 36.3°C on 28 Dec, a December record	2.2M customers out (later restated as 4.4M)	ANEEL intimation over Enel's contingency plan

The recurrence nobody has noticed: São Paulo's heat deaths are counted only when someone decides to look. CEInfo found 743 in February 2014; in November 2023, the city's clearest El Niño heat wave, nobody published a count. Over the same years, blackouts and heat have started arriving together: the 2023 windstorm came ten days before the record heat, so many people faced it without fans, lifts, or pumped water. Plans here are built around January floods, while the El Niño heat and wind arrive in spring.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

WHERE THE EXPERTS DISAGREE — UNRESOLVED

- **Buy fans for older people** (Philanthropist) versus **fans harm over-65s above 35°C in dry heat** (Skeptic). Verification sided with the Skeptic; fans are contraindicated.
- **Plan for the December–February peak** (the brief) versus **the window is spring** (Historian, Skeptic). Verification found the spring case rests on 2023 alone; two other cited extremes were not El Niño events. The report treats now to December as the heat and wind window and January–March as the flood window.
- **Neighbourhood grants** (Philanthropist) versus **the city's existing operation** (Emergency manager, Economist). Both survive: the first ask is free (site a tent, count deaths), and grants fill only the gaps the city leaves.
- **Use the Enel concession process as leverage** (Economist) versus **nothing lands this season** (verification). Moved to contraindicated.

WHAT NOBODY COVERED — BLIND SPOT

No lens looked at **dengue**, which heat and rain drive and which hit São Paulo with a record epidemic in 2024. No lens covered **care homes (ILPIs)** in the district, the **hospital cluster** around Bela Vista as surge capacity, or **wildfire smoke and air pollution**, which blanketed the city in September 2024. Delivery riders' actual protections were checked only through a bill that turned out not to cover them.

HOW TO READ THIS — METHOD

The panel is author-built. Seven simulated expert lenses were used to generate these recommendations. Where they agree, that is a strong hypothesis, not a consensus of the field. Every recommendation was then independently checked for evidence, transferability to this location, and feasibility before the peak; the verdict tags carry the result.

Mortality figures are resolved at Climate Impact Lab impact-region scale and are not neighbourhood figures. The El Niño projection covers *heat only*; floods, blackouts, dengue, and smoke are additional to it and are carried here by the historical record rather than by a published number.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

- **Scope.** The request named “Bela Vista, São Paulo”. Climate Impact Lab impact region, as this report records it: São Paulo municipality, *inferred* rather than resolved on the Impact Map. Impact regions follow second-level administrative units, so this one holds about 11.4 million people, roughly 40 times the usual 300,000. Local statistics are for the distrito da Bela Vista (Subprefeitura Sé, 60,024 people in 2022). Cortiço counts cover the wider centre and only partly overlap the district; health coverage is for UBS Humaitá's catchment.
- **Exposure.** Climate Impact Lab, *451,000 at Risk* (September 2026, pre-peer-review): ECMWF SEAS5 seasonal forecasts (51-member ensemble) applied to temperature–mortality relationships across 24,378 regions, against a 1996–2025 baseline. The Brazil figure is for September 2026 – February 2027. It covers heat only. It is never added to the Impact Map's long-run projections or quoted from the map's GDP-denominated mortality. The ~750 scaled figure is our population arithmetic.
- **Expert panel.** Seven simulated expert lenses (emergency manager, public health scientist, frontline responder, skeptic, economist, historian, and philanthropist) each researched this place independently and in parallel, from web sources including Portuguese-language ones, to a fixed brief.
- **Reconciliation.** Duplicate actions were merged and backing lenses recorded. Convergence was tested for shared bias: six lenses converged on welfare checks, but their evidence (Semenza, Benmarhnia) is North American, which the action states. Two lenses converged on a “spring window”, and verification found it rests on one clear year. Contradictions were kept, including fans. Actions were ranked by expected lives saved per unit of effort before the peak, given payers or marked unfunded, and reconciled against the funding placements.
- **Verification.** Six separate verifier agents checked 13 recommendations, the historical record, and the funding placements on evidence, transferability, and feasibility. Financial actions were also checked for availability, a named payer, a trigger, and whether they are already implemented. Verifiers read primary sources including Portaria 362/2025, REN 1000/2021, Lei 15.235/2025, PL 161/2025, the 2022 census district tables, and IFRC DREF documents. The envelope was re-summed.
- **Verdicts.** *Confirmed*: evidence, transferability, and feasibility all hold. *Partially confirmed*: holds after the corrections shown. *Unverified*: could not be checked to a primary source. *Contraindicated*: would do harm or waste the window here.
- **Adaptation Inventory.** Not consulted. The “Download Inventory” link leads to a registration form with no direct data file, and the inventory's map was not driven in a browser for Brazil. Every action is tagged “not consulted”, which is not the same as having no precedent.
- **Health wording.** Passages where a wording error could hurt someone (fans and cooling for older people, and medical equipment in a power outage) are marked "* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing." They were checked against published sources, not

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by a health professional. They are suggestions, not medical advice, and anyone passing them on should confirm them with a doctor, pharmacist, nurse, or community health worker first. The marker was added on 2 November 2026.

- **Rules.** No cost is derived by dividing a published total. Lens unit costs are labelled estimates. No local figure is invented; where data is thin, the report says so.
- **Limits.** The panel and verifiers are AI research agents working from web-available sources, not human experts, and no one in this place was interviewed. No official São Paulo heat death toll exists for 2023. The CPC table did not load, so ENSO phases for 2014 and 2024 are from the verifier's knowledge. The current 8 October CPC update was not retrieved. Achiropita's present capacity, a tent site inside the SMADS contract, and Consultório na Rua coverage of Bela Vista are unconfirmed.

References · verified by Phase 5 unless marked. Subprefeitura Sé, Bela Vista profile (verified) · Censo 2022 district tables (verified) · SEHAB cortiço census (verified) · UBS Humaitá (verified) · Portaria 362/2025, heat protocol (verified) · Semenza et al. 1996 (verified) · Benmarhnia et al. 2016 (corrected) · Monteiro dos Santos et al. 2024 (verified) · Son et al. 2016 (lens) · Rio excess mortality, Nov 2023 (verified) · CEInfo, February 2014 excess deaths (verified) · Registro Civil reporting lag (verified) · Operação Altas Temperaturas (verified) · OAT 2025–26 reactivation (verified) · CDC cooling-centre review (lens) · Decree 57.069/2016 and 57.581/2017 (verified) · Zeladoria subcommittee minute (lens) · Court order on belongings (corrected) · ANEEL REN 1000/2021 (verified) · ANEEL upholds Enel fine (verified) · Enel, December 2025 cyclone (verified) · ANEEL caducidade vote (verified) · Enel SP Conselho de Consumidores (verified) · Lei 15.235/2025 (verified) · Tarifa social enrolment fall (verified) · Saracura overflow, Jan 2021 (verified) · Line 6 worksite flood, Mar 2024 (corrected) · INMET, February rainfall records (corrected) · February 2020 floods (verified) · Anhangabaú drainage plan 2021 (verified) · Piscinões (corrected) · INMET, November 2023 (verified) · Climatempo, November 2023 temperatures (verified) · December 2025 record (verified) · November 2023 blackout (verified) · October 2024 blackout (verified) · Cantareira levels (lens) · CPC El Niño advisory, Sept 2026 (verified) · Grimm, ENSO teleconnections (corrected) · Fan effectiveness review (verified) · PL 161/2025 (verified) · Brazil parametric market (verified) · Anticipation Hub, Brazil (verified) · IFRC DREF anticipatory pillar (verified) · DREF MDRBR012, Brazil (verified) · Start Fund alert 871 (verified) · Achiropita work plan (corrected) · SEFRAS partnership (verified) · Missão Paz (verified) · Ebi et al. 2004, Philadelphia (verified) · Hess et al. 2018, Ahmedabad (verified) · Mobiliza Saracura Vai-Vai (lens) · Câmara SP, Bixiga migrants (lens)
Exposure data · Climate Impact Lab, 451,000 at Risk · Impact Map · Adaptation Inventory
Generated 8 October 2026 for Bela Vista, São Paulo. El Niño Ready is volunteer-run and is not affiliated with Climate Week NYC, The Climate Group, or Columbia University.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.